

MLIR NPU Compiler - Lecture 18

Custom NPU Dialect: npu.matmul / npu.dma / npu.barrier ODS Design

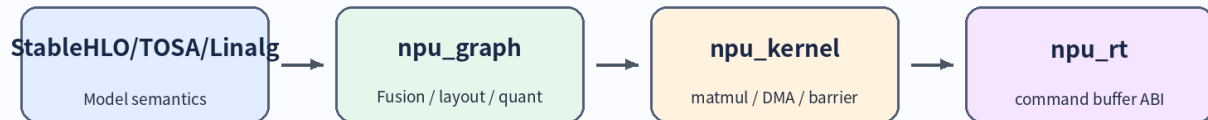
1. 강의 목표

- Custom NPU dialect 가 필요한 위치와 abstraction boundary 를 설명한다.
- ODS/TableGen 으로 operation contract 를 정의하는 방법을 익힌다.
- npu.matmul, npu.dma, npu.barrier 의 operands/results/attributes/verifier 를 설계한다.
- parser/printer, verifier, lowering, FileCheck test 를 하나의 dialect bring-up flow 로 연결한다.

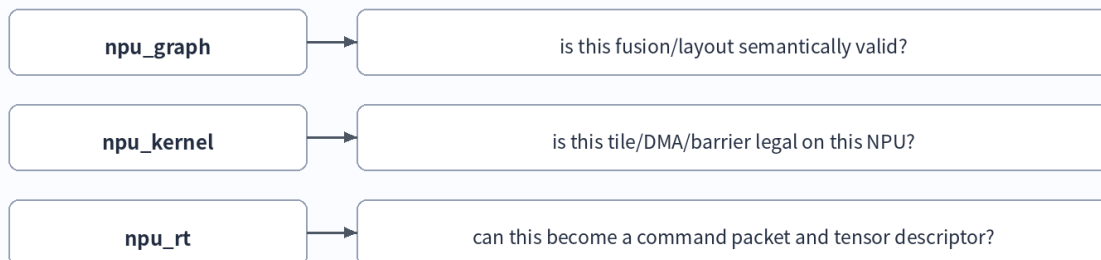
2. 왜 Custom NPU Dialect 인가?

NPU backend 는 native tile shape, SRAM/ACCUM memory space, DMA direction, barrier scope, accumulator width, epilogue policy 와 같은 target contract 를 필요로 합니다. custom dialect 는 이러한 hardware contract 를 operation/type/attribute/verifier 로 고정해 lowering pass 와 test 가 같은 의미를 공유하게 합니다.

Custom NPU Dialect Layering



What each layer verifies



3. ODS/TableGen 핵심

ODS 는 operation 구조의 single source of truth 입니다. op name, documentation, arguments, results, traits/interfaces, assembly format, verifier hook 를 TableGen record 로 선언하고 mlir-tblgen 이 C++ declaration/definition/doc skeleton 을 생성합니다.

ODS / TableGen Anatomy

```
def NPU_MatmulOp : NPU_Op<"matmul", [MemoryEffectsOpInterface]> {
  let arguments = (ins NPU_TileBuffer:$lhs, NPU_TileBuffer:$rhs,
    NPU_AccBuffer:$acc, NPU_TileShapeAttr:$tile,
    NPU_LayoutAttr:$lhs_layout, NPU_LayoutAttr:$rhs_layout);
  let results = (outs NPU_AccBuffer:$result);
  let assemblyFormat = "$lhs`, ` $rhs`, ` $acc attr-dict `:` ...";
  let hasVerifier = 1;
}
```

op name + namespace

operands/results typed by contract

attributes hold static target facts

assemblyFormat = readable IR

verifier = hardware legality

4. npu.matmul / npu.dma / npu.barrier contract

npu.matmul / npu.dma / npu.barrier Contracts

npu.matmul

- tile shape
- lhs/rhs layout
- accumulator type
- epilogue policy
- read/write effects

Verifier rejects illegal hardware contracts

npu.dma

- src/dst memory space
- elements or bytes
- stride policy
- async token
- alignment limits

Verifier rejects illegal hardware contracts

npu.barrier

- token operands
- scope attribute
- ordering semantics
- deadlock checks
- region boundary

Verifier rejects illegal hardware contracts

Op	Purpose	Verifier focus
npu.matmul	native tile compute command	tile shape, layout, dtype, accumulator, memory effects
npu.dma	asynchronous memory transfer	src/dst memory space, size, stride, alignment
npu.barrier	dependency/order command	non-empty tokens, scope, dependency consistency

5. ODS skeleton excerpt

```
//===- NPUOps.td - NPU dialect op definitions -----*- tablegen -*-===//
// Educational skeleton. Adapt constraints and namespaces for a real compiler.

#ifndef NPU_OPS_TD
#define NPU_OPS_TD

include "mlir/IR/OpBase.td"
include "mlir/Interfaces/SideEffectInterfaces.td"
include "mlir/Interfaces/InferTypeOpInterface.td"
include "NPUTypes.td"

def NPU_Dialect : Dialect {
  let name = "npu";
  let cppNamespace = "::mlir::npu";
  let summary = "Target-specific NPU kernel and command dialect";
  let description = [{
    Captures NPU tile-level compute, DMA, and synchronization contracts after
    tiling, layout, memory-space, and quantization decisions have been made.
  }];
}

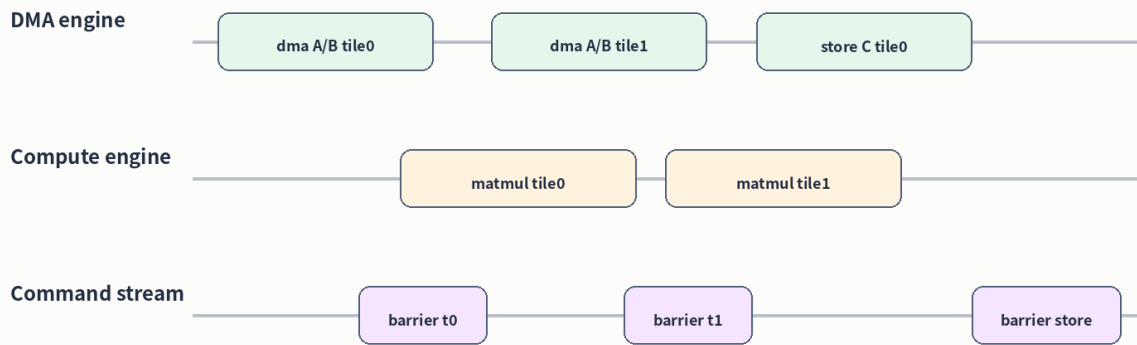
class NPU_Op<string mnemonic, list<Trait> traits = []> : Op<NPU_Dialect, mnemonic, traits>;

def NPU_MatmulOp : NPU_Op<"matmul", [
  DeclareOpInterfaceMethods<MemoryEffectsOpInterface>,
  DeclareOpInterfaceMethods<InferTypeOpInterface>
]> {
  let summary = "Issue one native NPU matrix multiply tile command";
  let arguments = (ins NPU_TileBuffer:$lhs, NPU_TileBuffer:$rhs,
    NPU_AccBuffer:$acc, NPU_TileShapeAttr:$stile,
    NPU_LayoutAttr:$lhs_layout, NPU_LayoutAttr:$rhs_layout,
    OptionalAttr<NPU_EpilogueAttr>:$epilogue);
  let results = (outs NPU_AccBuffer:$result);
  let assemblyFormat = [{
    $lhs ``,` $rhs ``,` $acc attr-dict ``
    type($lhs) ``,` type($rhs) ``,` type($acc) `->` type($result)
  }];
  let hasVerifier = 1;
  let hasCanonicalizer = 1;
}
```

6. DMA + Barrier command scheduling

npu.dma 는 asynchronous transfer 를 시작하고 token 을 반환합니다. npu.barrier 는 token 을 consume 하여 command order 를 명시합니다. 이 모델은 hardware tag-buffer 기반 DMA 로도 낮출 수 있고, command buffer generation 전 hazard verification 에도 유용합니다.

DMA + Barrier + MatMul Timeline

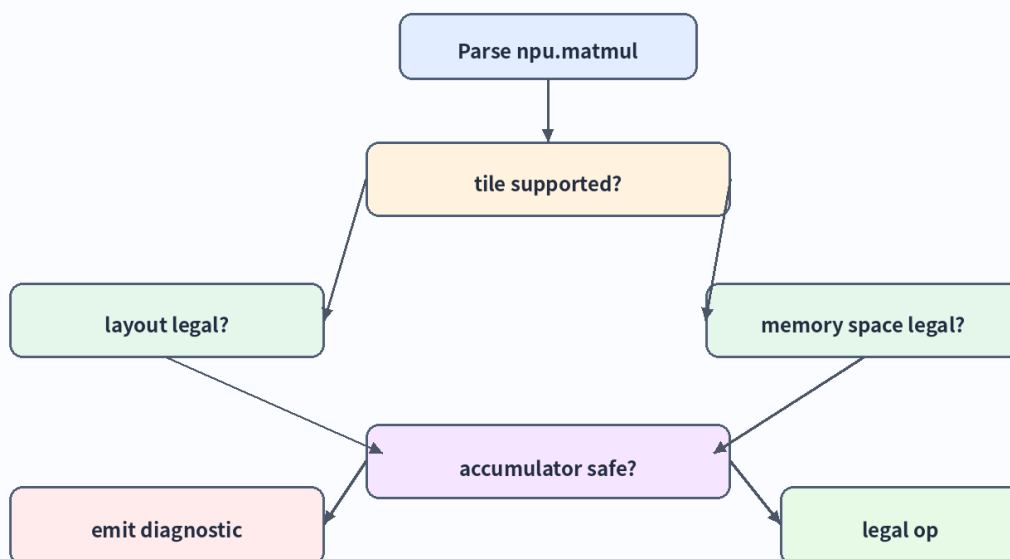


Design rule: expose tokens/barriers early enough to verify hazards, but late enough to preserve graph-level optimization.

7. Verifier 설계 원칙

Verifier 는 illegal IR 을 reject 해야 합니다. 단순히 느린 schedule 이나 덜 최적인 layout 은 verifier 가 아니라 cost model/fallback policy 가 판단해야 합니다.

Verifier Decision Tree



Verifier = legality. Cost model = profitability. Keep them separate.

8. 실습 과제

1. npu.matmul fields 를 operand/type/attribute 로 분류한다.
2. npu.dma token-based ODS skeleton 을 작성한다.
3. unsupported tile shape negative verifier test 를 작성한다.
4. vector.contract -> npu.matmul lowering legality matrix 를 작성한다.

9. 참고자료

- MLIR Defining Dialects: <https://mlir.llvm.org/docs/DefiningDialects/>
- MLIR Operation Definition Specification (ODS): <https://mlir.llvm.org/docs/DefiningDialects/Operations/>
- MLIR Creating a Dialect: <https://mlir.llvm.org/docs/Tutorials/CreatingADialect/>
- MLIR Customizing Assembly Behavior: <https://mlir.llvm.org/docs/DefiningDialects/Assembly/>
- MLIR Defining Dialect Attributes and Types: <https://mlir.llvm.org/docs/DefiningDialects/AttributesAndTypes/>
- MLIR MemRef Dialect: <https://mlir.llvm.org/docs/Dialects/MemRef/>
- MLIR Testing Guide: https://mlir.llvm.org/getting_started/TestingGuide/